ROYAL BRITISH LEGION - PARIS BRANCH

ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, 25th NOVEMBER 2013

TREASURER'S REPORT

BRANCH ACCOUNTS FOR THE 9 MONTHS ENDED 30th JUNE 2013

I am pleased to present to the AGM the Branch Accounts for the Paris Branch.

Before going into the detail there are two points that I would like to mention specifically, as they represent a break with past practice:

1. The Legion decided some time ago that the accounting period for branches would change and the "Field Year", as it is called at RBL London, would end on 30th June, as of 2013. The main reason for this is to give more time to the Finance team at RBL HQ to prepare the consolidated accounts for the charity, which still cover the year from October 1 to September 30. The only impact that this has had for us is that the Branch Accounts presented to you cover, exceptionally, the **9 months** from 1st October 2012 to 30th June 2013. The next set of accounts will be for the 12-month period from 1st July 2013 to 30th June 2014.

2. After reviewing the reporting requirements for our Association Loi 1901 (the local legal structure of the Paris Branch of RBL), and of course after referring to and discussing with both David Blanchard, the previous Treasurer and John Greenwood, our Honorary Auditor, the decision has been taken not to produce a Balance Sheet. There is no requirement locally to produce this document and it is not part of the financial reporting package that we send to RBL in London. After discussion with the Chairman, Vice-Chairman and Secretary, all were in agreement with my suggestion. This has considerably simplified the process of producing the figures.

Therefore my presentation covers the document that RBL London calls the Branch Accounts and focuses on the income and expenditure of the Paris Branch.

One other point should made - in the past both this document and the Balance Sheet that you are used to seeing have included an estimation of the value of the premises at rue des Acacias, but this year RBL London has decided to carry out all the valuations centrally and branches have been given the specific instruction not to complete the 'Property Value' boxes at line 39 (page 3) or line 41 (page 4). This means that is not possible to indicate the Total Net Assets of Branch (line 46).

Turning now to the presentation of the document: -

Administration Fund/General Account (pages 2 & 3):

- **Receipts and Payments (pages 2 and 3)**

For the 9 months in question the surplus on the General Account was €952, compared to €1110 for the 12 month period last year,

Despite the shorter period total receipts (income) were stable, (€11 203 v €11 049), with net fundraising income up by €1 285 to €3 610 (Net Sweepstake and Tombola income accounted for €899 of this increase, the remainder comes from other fund-raising events such as monthly lunches). However net subscription income was down by 9.6% and in the current low interest rate environment, Interest Received was significantly lower, even though the balances on deposit have changed little.

Branch Administration costs at €1 634 remain under tight control, although please remember that this is a 9 month figure, so the comparable annual figure would be in the range €2 000-€2 200, compared with €2 445 for the last full year. Premises costs of €6 397 (which the Legion classifies as "Property Transactions") are up on a like for like basis, as the annual rate would be €8000-€8500, compared with €6458 last year. The main reason for this is the cost of property improvements undertaken during the year.

- **Bank and Cash Balances (page 4)**

The **Administration Fund/General Account** cash position has increased by the surplus of €952 to €38 642. We still have a healthy balance on deposit at the bank.

Poppy Appeal Fund/Welfare Account (pages 3 & 4):

- **Donations and poppy sales** for the 9 months were at the same level as the previous full year (€15 846 v €16 140). Relief payments made to the British Charitable Fund increased by €2 000 to €12 500 and other welfare payments totalled €93.
- We show a net excess of income over outgoings for the year of € 2 278 and the **Poppy Appeal Fund/Welfare Account** cash position stands at €16 025.

Audit and Submission to RBL London

The Branch Committee approved these figures at their meeting in September and our Auditor, John Greenwood, subsequently signed them off. They were then sent to RBL London together with supporting documentation.

The Branch Accounts are now presented to you at this Annual General Meeting and confirmation of the approval that I ask you now to give will be confirmed by the Branch Secretary on Page 1 of the document and resent to London.

Ian McDonald

Honorary Treasurer
25th November 2013